Worksheet for Edward Curtis'
"Our Great Physician"
by Fareen Momen
(to be used with video linked here)

Key Takeaways:

1. In Majied's cartoon "*Our Great Physician*," how is Elijah Muhammad visually portrayed as a healer, and what elements of the image help construct that role?

2. Why did many early scholars, journalists, and officials claim the Nation of Islam was political rather than religious? How does this contrast with how NOI members viewed Elijah Muhammad?

3. The patient's diagnosis claims that Black people were "deaf and dumb," meaning disconnected from their true identity. Which symbols under the hospital bed represent the NOI's idea of harmful "pathologies," and what does rejecting them symbolize?

4. How does the cartoon use medical imagery—such as the patient, diagnosis chart, and "physician"—to communicate the NOI's message about healing from the effects of white supremacy?

Contextualizing the Work

Can you think of another moment in history when a movement framed itself as offering "healing," "cure," or "salvation" from social or political problems? How does that compare to how the Nation of Islam presents Elijah Muhammad in this image?